TM-002 (T.M., 22, 69% Emotional) | TRAUMA-001 | CSP Pro Bono | Friday Oct 24, 2026 6:00 PM PST | Zoom | ~105 min (extended) | **READ TOP TO BOTTOM — THERAPIST ONLY**

SESSION STRUCTURE: Phases 1–5 (check-in, baselines, recap, pre-talk, recording) → Phases 6–7 (induction + deepening) → Phases 8–14 (Circle Therapy: 4 extinction cycles + reversal + compound anchor) → **Self-Esteem Imagery (workshop, 5 workbenches, critic→coach, gauges, future pace)** → Phases 15–17 (count out, debrief, homework). Appendix: Self-Esteem Toolkit handout for client.

SESSION-WIDE RULES: Emotional lane throughout: permissive, imagery, "you may notice," NO direct commands. Circle Therapy principle: anxiety + deep relaxation = physiologically incompatible. NEVER increase cycle intensity if body has not settled from previous cycle. Exit signal = right index finger. If abreaction during cycle: deepen, stay IN circle, ground with circle warmth, do NOT count out. Anchor: thumb+forefinger RIGHT hand (from S2a) — compound with circle tonight. Record Steps 5–12.

PHASE 1: OPENING + CHECK-IN ~5 MIN

SAY: "Hey Tristan, good to see you. How are you doing tonight?"

DO: Let him settle. Match his energy. Observe posture, eye contact, tone vs. Session 2.

SAY: "Before we get into tonight's work, I want to check in on how the week has been since our last session. A few quick questions."

ASK: "How has your week been overall since our session on the 16th?"

Let him talk 2–3 min. Do NOT rush. Listen for: emotional shifts, triggering events, sleep quality, energy level.

ASK: "Did you practice the tribe visualization before sleep? How did that go?"

ASK: "Did you use the thumb-forefinger anchor? When? What happened when you pressed them together?"

ASK: "Any moments where the rescuer-helper reframe kicked in — where you caught yourself shifting from 'they're disrespecting me' to 'they're struggling'?"

ASK: "Did you notice anything about your self-talk this week? How you talk to yourself when something goes wrong?"

ASK: "Any dreams? Nightmares still happening — the fighting, revenge ones?"

ASK: "Any triggering incidents this week? Situations where the old pattern fired?"

ASK: "Did you get a chance to listen to the session recording?"

If homework not done: "What made it difficult?" (barriers, not resistance). Do NOT interpret missed homework as sabotage. His answer reveals barriers.

If he completed the feedback form, reference specific items: "I saw you rated [X] — tell me about that."

RECORD: Homework compliance: tribe viz Y/N, anchor Y/N, reframe Y/N, self-talk Y/N, dreams Y/N, recording Y/N, feedback form Y/N

PHASE 2: SMART BASELINES — NON-NEGOTIABLE ~5 MIN

FIRST TIME COLLECTING FORMALLY. Deferred from S1 and S2. DO NOT SKIP.

SAY: "Okay. Before we move into tonight's work, I need to collect some baseline numbers. Six areas, scale of 1 to 10. No right or wrong answers. Just how you feel right now, tonight, sitting here."

ASK: "Self-esteem: 1 means no value in who I am, 10 means confident and worthy. Where are you tonight?"

RECORD: SE: ___/10

ASK: "Assertiveness: 1 means I cannot speak up or set boundaries, 10 means I comfortably express my needs. Where are you?"

RECORD: AS: ___/10

ASK: "Anxiety — and this one is inverted: 1 means anxiety runs the show constantly, 10 means calm and in control. So higher is better. Where are you?"

Clarify the direction. Make sure he gets that 10 = calm.

RECORD: AX: ___/10

ASK: "Trust: 1 means I cannot trust anyone, guard always up. 10 means I am open and safe with people I choose. Where are you?"

RECORD: TR: ___/10

ASK: "Comfort in your own skin: 1 means deeply uncomfortable being me, 10 means at ease and at home in who I am. Where are you?"

RECORD: CO: ___/10

ASK: "Influence of the past: 1 means my past controls everything I do, 10 means I am aware of my past but it does not run my life. Where are you?"

RECORD: PI: ___/10

RECORD: **ALL 6 BASELINES: SE___ AS___ AX___ TR___ CO___ PI___**

SAY: "Good. Those are your baseline numbers. We will collect them again next session and see how they move. No pressure on where they are tonight — this is just the starting point."

PHASE 3: SESSION 2 RECAP + BRIDGE TO TONIGHT ~3 MIN

SAY: "Let me quickly recap what we built last session, because tonight connects directly to it."

SAY: "Last session we established something important: your reactions are not your identity. Emotions are situational. They are triggered by specific inputs and they do not define who you are. Labeling yourself based on a momentary reaction — calling yourself an asshole when you have a judgmental thought — that binds behavior to identity. And that damages your self-esteem unnecessarily."

SAY: "We identified the loop: perceived disrespect triggers defensive anger, then guilt about the anger, then self-labeling, then shame. That cycle is exactly what we are rewiring."

SAY: "We also built something in deep relaxation. You built a circle of 11 supportive figures around you — your soul tribe — each one representing a quality you need. Bravery. Care. Self-esteem. Belonging. All of them. They were integrated into your body and sealed with protective golden light."

SAY: "And we installed the anchor — thumb and forefinger, right hand — that brings you back to that protected, self-assured state."

SAY: "You told me after that session that you felt 'more steady' and that it was 'almost like having an armor or a shield.' That is real. That protection is yours. And tonight we are going to build on top of it."

PHASE 4: CIRCLE THERAPY PRE-TALK ~3 MIN

SAY: "Tonight we are doing something specific with the triggers you have been carrying."

SAY: "You know that feeling when a voice gets loud and your body locks up? And that feeling when someone gets close and your guard goes up? Those are conditioned responses. Your nervous system learned them in childhood. And they were smart then. They kept you safe. But they are running on old software now."

SAY: "Here is what your brain does not know yet: your body cannot feel deep relaxation and fear at the same time. They are physically incompatible. It is like trying to speed up and brake with the same pedal. The nervous system has to pick one."

SAY: "So what we are going to do is put you in a deeply relaxed state — deeper than last time — and then gently introduce those triggers. Not in real life. In your mind. In a safe, controlled way. And each time the trigger appears, your nervous system will try to fire the fear response. But it will hit the wall of relaxation. And it will not be able to hold. The fear rises, meets the calm, and dissolves. We do that a few times, and the old wiring starts to weaken. Each cycle takes power away from the trigger."

SAY: "You are going to stand inside a protective circle. That circle connects to the tribe energy from last session. The golden aura IS the circle. Inside it, nothing can touch you. The triggers exist outside the circle. You observe them from inside. And each time you observe them without the fear running, a new pathway forms."

SAY: "Make sense?"

DO: PAUSE. Wait for confirmation. Answer any questions. If he asks "will it work?": "It works because your nervous system follows rules. And one of those rules is: relaxation overrides fear when both are present. We are going to use that rule tonight."

PHASE 5: RECORDING NOTICE ~1 MIN

START RECORDING NOW.

SAY: "We are about to move into the relaxation and therapeutic portion. I am starting the recording now. You signed the consent in advance — you are comfortable with me recording this portion?"

DO: Wait for verbal confirmation. If declined: proceed without recording, note in post-session checklist.

SAY: "Good. This is a hypnotherapy session recording for T.M. You can listen to this between sessions. Find a quiet place. Do not listen while driving. Close your eyes and follow my voice."

PHASE 6: INDUCTION ~8 MIN

SAY: "If at any point you want to pause or stop, raise your right index finger. That is your signal. I will stop immediately. You are always in control."

SAY: "Get comfortable. Adjust anything you need. When you are ready, I want you to place your hand gently on your chest."

Wait. Let him settle.

SAY: "I want you to repeat after me, out loud. Say it and mean it."

SAY: "I am great."

DO: Wait for him to repeat.

SAY: "I am a wonderful person."

DO: Wait for him to repeat.

SAY: "Everybody genuinely likes me."

DO: Wait for him to repeat.

SAY: "I am being loved."

DO: Wait for him to repeat.

SAY: "Good. Now find a spot on the wall in front of you. Fix your eyes on that spot. And as you look at that spot, I want you to see your own face — but the best version of your face. The version that shows pride. Bravery. Fulfillment. See that face. Store that image."

DO: PAUSE 5–7 sec.

SAY: "Now, three deep breaths with me. Breathe in through your nose. Fill your lungs completely. Hold. And release slowly through your mouth. Let the breath carry tension out of your body."

DO: Breathe with him. 3 full cycles. Match his pace.

SAY: "Second breath. In through the nose. Hold. Release. Shoulders drop. Jaw softens."

SAY: "Third breath. Deepest one. In. Hold. And release everything. Let the eye muscles relax. Let the forehead smooth out."

SAY: "Now allow your eyes to close. Whenever they are ready. No rush. Let those eyelids grow heavy. And when they close, just let them stay closed."

Wait for eyes to close naturally. Do NOT command. If 15 sec: "You can allow those eyelids to grow heavy now."

SAY: "Deep Sleep."

PHS: "Each and every time I suggest the words Deep Sleep, for the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, you will enter this state safely and comfortably, at your own pace, quickly, calmly, and deeply, and the body and mind will settle."

PHASE 7: DEEPENING ~7 MIN

SAY: "I am going to count from five down to zero. Each number, your subconscious allows you deeper. Safely. Comfortably. At your own pace."

SAY: "Five. Settling in. Safe. The body beginning to let go."

SAY: "Four. The outside world getting quieter. Farther away. Only my voice matters."

SAY: "Three. Body heavy. Mind calm. Twice as deep."

SAY: "Two. So deep. So safe. Everything letting go."

SAY: "One. Deeper still."

SAY: "Zero. Deep Sleep. All the way down."

PHS: "For the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, safely and comfortably, the body and mind are settled."

SAY: "And now I am going to count to three. On three, Deep Sleep. Ten times deeper. One. Two. Three. Deep Sleep. Ten times deeper."

SAY: "Again. One. Two. Three. Deep Sleep. Another ten times deeper. One hundred times deeper than the start. Perfectly safe. Perfectly comfortable."

SAY: **STAIRCASE:** "Now see yourself at the top of a staircase. Well built. Solid. Handrails on both sides. Well lit. Safe. Ten steps down. Each step, deeper."

SAY: "Ten. Starting down. Nine. Twice as deep. Eight. Seven. Twice as deep again. Six. Five. Halfway. You can see the destination — a warm, sunlit space. Open. Spacious. Just light and warmth and peace. Four. Three. Twice as deep. Two. One. Step off into that sunlit space. Warm. Bright. Safe."

PHS: "Deep Sleep. Even deeper now. For the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, body and mind settled. Safe. Comfortable. Ready."

SAY: **ABBREVIATED BODY SCAN:** "A warm wave of relaxation beginning at the crown of your head. Moving down across your forehead. Smoothing every line. Down through the eyes. The jaw. Let the jaw go loose. Down into the neck. The shoulders. And here — at the shoulders — allow any weight that was never yours to carry to melt away. Just release it. It was never yours."

SAY: "Down through the arms. The hands. Into the chest. The stomach — the part that tightens when you feel unsafe. You are safe here. Let it soften. Down through the hips. The legs. The feet. The toes. Every cell relaxed. Every muscle at rest. Safe. Settled."

SAY: "Any outside sound will only help you go deeper. Only my voice matters. You are safe."

Observe: body sinking, facial smoothing, slowed breathing, REM under lids. Note trance depth.

RECORD: Trance signs: ___

TIME CHECK + TRANSITION: CIRCLE THERAPY → SELF-ESTEEM IMAGERY ~28 MIN REMAINING

You are still in trance after the Phase 14 seal. Do NOT count out yet. Bridge directly into the workshop imagery. If running short on time (<20 min left), skip to Phase 15 count out and save self-esteem for Session 4.

SAY: "And now, still in this deep state, I want to take you somewhere new. Not the circle. Somewhere you have never been. A place your subconscious is about to build for you."

TRANSITION: SELF-ESTEEM SEALED → COUNT OUT

Self-esteem PHS delivered. Workshop sealed. Now proceed to standard count out. The count out seals BOTH Circle Therapy AND Self-Esteem work together.

PHASE 8: BUILD THE PROTECTIVE CIRCLE ~2 MIN

SAY: "Now, in this deep state of relaxation, I want you to see something forming on the ground around you. A circle. A ring of light. Warm. Golden. About six feet in diameter. You are standing right at the center."

SAY: "This circle is your protection. Inside this circle, the relaxation holds. No matter what appears outside it. No matter what you see or hear beyond the ring. Inside the circle, you are calm. Inside the circle, your nervous system stays in its resting state."

SAY: "This circle connects to your tribe. The 11 who integrated with you last session. Their energy IS this light. The golden aura you sealed — it is alive. It is here. And it forms the walls of this circle."

SAY: "Feel the warmth of the circle under your feet. Feel it rise up around you like a column of warm light. You are enclosed. You are protected. And from inside this circle, you can observe anything — any memory, any sound, any trigger — without the old reaction running. Because the circle will not let it through."

SAY: "When you feel the circle around you — solid, warm, protective — let a nod happen."

DO: Wait for ideomotor nod. Do NOT proceed without it. If no nod after 20 sec: "Take your time. When you feel it, that nod will come on its own."

RECORD: Circle nod: Y / N / subtle. Time: ___

PHASE 9: CYCLE 1 — DISRESPECT / RAISED VOICE (LOW INTENSITY) ~4 MIN

SAY: "Good. Now, outside the circle, at a distance — far away, like across a large field — I want you to notice a sound. A man's voice. Not close. Not loud. Just a voice in the distance. A raised voice. The kind that used to mean danger. But it is far away. And you are inside the circle."

DO: PAUSE 5–7 sec. Watch for body response: jaw tightening, breath change, shoulders rising.

SAY: "Notice what your body does. Does it tighten? Does the old pattern try to run? That is okay. Let it try. But notice where you are. Inside the circle. The warmth around you. The relaxation in your muscles. The calm in your chest."

SAY: "The fear tries to fire. But it hits the relaxation. And it cannot hold. It is like trying to light a match in the rain. The conditions will not support it."

SAY: "Watch the fear rise. And watch it fall. It cannot sustain itself. Not here. Not inside the circle. The voice is out there. You are in here. And the calm is stronger."

DO: PAUSE 10 sec. Let the nervous system process: fear signal sent, relaxation response dominant, fear signal fades. ONE CYCLE COMPLETE.

SAY: "Good. The voice fades. The fear fades with it. And something has changed. The pathway between 'raised voice' and 'fear response' just lost a little bit of its charge. One cycle. One weakening. You did not fight the fear. You did not resist it. You simply let the relaxation outrun it. And it worked."

SAY: "Deep Sleep. Even deeper. Resetting the calm. Restoring the base. The circle holds."

RECORD: Cycle 1 body response: ___ Time to dissipate: ___

Cycle 1 complete. Low-intensity yelling (distant). Fear attempted, overridden by trance relaxation.

PHASE 10: CYCLE 2 — DISRESPECT / RAISED VOICE (MEDIUM INTENSITY) ~4 MIN

GATE: Only proceed if body settled from Cycle 1. If still showing tension, repeat Cycle 1 at same intensity. Do NOT escalate into unresolved activation.

SAY: "Now the voice returns. But this time, it is closer. Not right next to you. But closer. Like someone in the next room. The volume is higher. You can hear the tone. The sharpness. The anger in it. The kind of voice that used to make your whole body freeze."

SAY: "And notice your body. The old pattern fires faster this time. The tightness comes quicker. The guard wants to go up. That is the old wiring. Doing what it was trained to do. But watch what happens."

SAY: "The circle holds. The warmth does not waver. The relaxation in your body is deeper than the fear. The fear is a wave crashing against a seawall. It hits. It sprays. And it pulls back. Because the wall is solid. The circle is solid. And you are inside it."

DO: PAUSE 10–15 sec. Harder cycle. If significant distress: "Breathe. The circle holds. Deep Sleep. Deeper. The wave is pulling back." If abreaction: stop cycle, deepen trance, ground in circle warmth, do NOT proceed to higher intensity.

SAY: "The voice fades again. And the fear fades faster this time. Notice that. Faster. The first time, the fear lingered. This time, it dissipated sooner. Because the pathway is already weaker. Two cycles. Two weakenings. The wiring that once ran your life is losing its charge."

SAY: "And your body is learning something new. Loud voice does not equal danger. Loud voice equals a moment to breathe, a moment to ground, a moment to stay inside the circle. The meaning is changing. Not the sound. The meaning."

SAY: **RESCUER REFRAME:** "And remember — the rescuer in you sees it clearly now. Their anger is not about you. Their anger is their struggle. Their anger is their call for help. And you — from inside your circle — you can see that. Without losing yourself. Without your inner self being breached."

SAY: "Deep Sleep. Even deeper. The circle restores. The calm deepens. You are doing extraordinary work right now."

RECORD: Cycle 2: faster dissipation? Y / N. Body response: ___

Cycle 2 complete. Medium-intensity yelling (closer, louder). Pathway weakening confirmed.

PHASE 11: CYCLE 3 — VULNERABILITY / BEING SEEN

~5 MIN

MOST IMPORTANT CYCLE. His stated fear (group vulnerability, being judged, feeling "less than"). Go slow. Give full time.

SAY: "Good. The voices are gone. The circle is quiet. And now a different kind of trigger appears. Not a sound. A situation."

SAY: "Outside the circle, a room appears. People sitting in a ring. A group setting. Faces looking toward the center. Open. Curious. Patient."

SAY: "Notice what happens in your body. Not to the sound of yelling this time. To the experience of being looked at. Being observed. Being seen without your walls up. What does your body do?"

DO: PAUSE 10 sec. Vulnerability fear typically lives in the chest (tightness, closing) rather than stomach/jaw. Note where his body responds.

SAY: "There it is. The tightness. The impulse to look away, to build the wall, to disappear, to perform. That is the old response. Being seen equals being judged. Being exposed. Being found out. That was the message encoded in childhood."

SAY: "But inside the circle, the response cannot run. The relaxation holds. The warmth holds. And you stand here, inside your circle of light, and you let these faces look at you. Not the performed version. The real version. And the fear rises. And it meets the calm. And it dissolves. Because in deep relaxation, the shame cannot sustain itself. The exposure does not produce the catastrophe."

DO: PAUSE 10–15 sec. Let the cycle complete fully.

SAY: "And now — something shifts. Step forward. And notice: the circle MOVES WITH YOU. It is YOUR energy. It goes where you go."

SAY: "You are in the group AND in your circle at the same time. Protected and present. Armored and open. Both things. At once."

SAY: "Open your mouth. Say one real thing. It does not matter what. The room receives it. No judgment. No attack. Just receiving."

SAY: "The vulnerability did not destroy you. It connected you. You are seen. And you are still whole."

DO: Wait for ideomotor nod (up to 60 sec). If no nod: "Take your time. When you feel something has shifted, even slightly, let a nod happen."

SAY: "Deep Sleep. Deeper. Resetting. Restoring. The circle holds."

RECORD: Cycle 3: body response (where) ___ nod Y/N ___ what he described ___

Cycle 3 complete. Vulnerability/being-seen exposure. Shame-based response extinguished.

PHASE 12: CYCLE 4 — TRUSTING SOMEONE CLOSE (OPTIONAL) ~5 MIN

GATE: ONLY if Cycles 1–3 landed well and he has capacity. Skip to Phase 13 (Reversal) if at capacity. Three good cycles = strong session. Four is a bonus.

SAY: "One more, if you are ready. Inside the circle, I want you to imagine someone standing with you. Not outside the circle. Inside it. Someone you care about. Someone you WANT to trust. Someone who has been safe so far. Your subconscious knows who."

DO: Let him choose. Do NOT suggest who. RECORD who appears.

SAY: "They are inside the circle with you. Close. Close enough to see your face. Close enough that if you opened up — if you shared something real, something vulnerable, something you normally keep behind the wall — they would hear it. They would receive it."

SAY: "And notice what your body does. The guard fires. The wall tries to go up. The old programming: closeness equals danger. Even with a safe person. Even inside the circle. The wiring does not care who it is. It fires at proximity. At intimacy. At the possibility of being known."

SAY: "But here, inside the circle, in this deep state of calm — the wall cannot fully form. The relaxation dissolves it as fast as it builds. Like trying to stack blocks on water. They will not hold. Because the base is too calm. And the wall, for the first time, cannot complete itself."

DO: PAUSE 10–15 sec. Trust fear is slower to extinguish. One cycle will not erase the pattern. But it CREATES A REFERENCE EXPERIENCE of closeness without the wall completing.

SAY: "And something happens that you may not expect. The person in the circle does not take advantage of the open wall. They do not rush in. They do not grab. They do not hurt. They are just there. Present. Patient. Warm. And the space between you and them — the space where the wall used to stand — that space becomes something else. Not empty. Not dangerous. Connected. Like a bridge instead of a gap. A bridge you built. That you can cross or not. Your choice."

SAY: "Trust is not a light switch. It is a dimmer. You control the dial. And tonight, the dial moved. Even a little."

If he places the lost friend or an abuser: do NOT redirect. "You decide how close."

SAY: "Deep Sleep. Deeper. The circle holds both of you. You are safe. They are safe. The bridge is there whenever you want to use it."

RECORD: Cycle 4: who appeared ___ wall disrupted Y/N ___ body response ___

Cycle 4 complete. Trust/intimacy exposure. New reference: closeness without catastrophe.

PHASE 13: REVERSAL SUGGESTION ~2 MIN

SAY: "Now I want you to try something. From inside the circle, in this deep state of relaxation, I want you to try to feel the old fear. Try to bring it back. The fear of the raised voice. The fear of being seen. The fear of trusting. Try to summon it. Really try."

DO: PAUSE 10–15 sec. Watch body closely.

SAY: "And notice something interesting. The harder you try to summon that old fear, the more distant it becomes. The more slippery. Like trying to grab smoke. Like trying to hold water in open hands. It was there a few minutes ago. But now, when you reach for it deliberately, it slips away. Because the relaxation has changed the terrain. The ground the fear used to stand on has shifted. And it cannot find its footing."

SAY: "That is the reversal. The old pattern ran automatically for years. But when you try to run it on purpose, it cannot. Because automatic fear and deliberate effort are different systems. And by trying to summon it and failing, your subconscious is registering a new truth: the old response is losing its power. Not because you are fighting it. Because the ground has changed."

SAY: "And each day, the ground changes a little more. Each time you encounter the trigger and the fear does not fully run, the pathway weakens further. Until one day, the trigger fires and the fear simply does not come. Not because you suppressed it. Because there is nothing left to fire."

RECORD: Reversal: could he summon the fear? Y / N. How hard did he try? Body response: ___

PHASE 14: COMPOUND ANCHOR + POST-HYPNOTIC + SEAL ~5 MIN

SAY: "Now I want to give you something you can take with you. Press your thumb and forefinger together. Right hand. The same anchor from last session."

DO: PAUSE 3 sec. Let him press.

SAY: "And feel the circle light up around you. The tribe energy. The golden light. The rescuer-helper. The armor. The shield. And now — the circle. The calm that no fear could override tonight. All of it. In one press. One gesture. One breath."

SAY: "The anchor is compounded now. It is not just the tribe from last session. It is the tribe AND the circle AND the extinction of fear AND the reversal. All of it. Layered. Braided. Stronger than before."

DO: PAUSE 5–7 sec. Let the compound anchor encode.

SAY: "Release the fingers. The circle stays warm. The gesture is stored. From this moment forward, anytime you press your thumb and forefinger together on your right hand, the circle activates. The calm returns. The protection engages. It does not matter where you are. In a meeting. On the street. In a difficult conversation. One gesture. One breath. The circle is there. Anywhere. Anytime."

SAY: "And it stacks with the breathing anchor. Thumb and forefinger together. One breath in. 'I am [word 1] and I am [word 2] and I like it.' Hand on heart if you want the full stack. The circle, the breath, the words, the touch. The calm is not a single thread. It is a rope. Braided. Strong. And it gets stronger every time you use it."

SAY: **POST-HYPNOTIC:** "And here is the part that changes everything. Between now and our next session, when the old triggers appear — a raised voice, a vulnerable moment, someone asking you to trust — the circle will activate automatically. Before the fear. Before the wall. Before the freeze. The circle fires first. The calm arrives first. And then, only then, you decide how to respond. Not from fear. From calm. Not from the child's rules. From the adult's choice."

SAY: "Each time the trigger fires and the circle catches it, the old pathway weakens. Each time you stay calm when you used to freeze, another thread in the old wiring frays. And each time you notice it — each time you think, 'I stayed calm in a moment where I used to lose it' — the new pathway doubles in strength. Notice it. Celebrate it quietly. That is the circle doing its work."

SAY: "Your identity is not your reactions. Your reactions are weather. Your identity is the sky."

SAY: **VENTING DREAM:** "In the early morning hours, your subconscious will process and clear what no longer serves you. Vivid or unusual dreams are subconscious housecleaning. Let them do their work."

PHS: "For the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, safely and comfortably, everything that happened inside this circle tonight is sealed into your subconscious mind. The extinction of the old fear pathways. The reversal. The anchor. The circle itself. All of it. Sealed. Protected. Growing stronger with each passing day."

SAY: "The circle is part of you now. It goes where you go. It holds when you need it. And it grows as you grow."

PHASE 15: COUNT OUT ~3 MIN

SAY: "Zero. Close the door to the subconscious. Seal in every positive suggestion. Block all negatives. Only the positive enters. Only the positive remains."

SAY: "One. Begin to feel your body. The surface underneath you. Your feet. The temperature of the room. The weight of your hands."

SAY: "Two. Fingers begin to move. Toes wiggle. A small stretch if your body wants it."

SAY: "Three. Halfway back. Feeling refreshed. Rested. Clear-headed. Whatever you processed tonight is settled deep. Working for you."

SAY: "Four. More alert now. Sounds around you. Light beyond your eyelids. Carrying something new. The circle is with you."

SAY: "Five. Eyes open. Wide awake. Fully alert. Welcome back."

STOP RECORDING.

DO: Give him a moment. Smile. Let him orient. Water if available.

PHASE 16: DEBRIEF ~5 MIN

ASK: "How do you feel?"

DO: Give time. Do not prompt with specific emotions. Let him describe in his own words.

ASK: "What stood out? What did you notice?"

ASK: "Which cycle was the hardest? The voices? The group? The trust?"

ASK: "When I asked you to try to summon the fear back — what happened?"

ASK: "How does this compare to last session? The armor and shield feeling — is it still there? Different?"

If shift reported: "Good. Your subconscious doing its work." If nothing obvious: "Sometimes the shift happens after. Over the next few days, notice subtle changes."

RECORD: Debrief: feeling ___ what stood out ___ hardest cycle ___ reversal result ___ compare to S2 ___

RECORD: Depth: ___/10. Anchor compound response: visible Y/N.

PHASE 17: HOMEWORK + SAFETY + CLOSE ~5 MIN

SAY: "Great session. Let me give you your updated practices for the week."

SAY: "Five things."

SAY: "One. Thumb and forefinger anchor daily. It is compounded now — it includes the tribe energy AND the circle. Use it every morning, and anytime you need it during the day. One press. One breath."

SAY: "Two. Before sleep: circle plus tribe visualization. Picture the golden circle on the ground around you. The 11 members of your tribe. Fall asleep inside it."

SAY: "Three. When triggered: one press, one breath, let the circle fire. Notice whether the fear is weaker. Notice whether the gap between trigger and response is wider."

SAY: "Four. Notice when the rescuer-helper activates naturally. When you catch yourself shifting from 'they're attacking me' to 'they're struggling.' That is the new wiring working."

SAY: "Five. Listen to tonight's recording at least once. Quiet place. Eyes closed. Let your subconscious do the work."

ASK: "Can you do those five things?"

DO: Wait for verbal commitment.

SAY: **SAFETY:** "Same as always. If anything feels overwhelming between now and next session — first, the anchor. Thumb and forefinger, one breath. Second, email me: jeeth@vrishihypno.com. I respond within 24 hours. Third, if urgent or if you have thoughts of self-harm: call or text 988. Suicide and Crisis Lifeline. 24/7. You are not alone."

SAY: "We will schedule session 4 after you have had a week to let tonight settle. I will send you the recording and a feedback form."

SAY: "What you did tonight was real work. You stepped into the circle. You faced the triggers. You watched the fear dissolve. Something shifted. I could see it. And you will keep feeling it over the next few days. See you next session."

SAY: "Thank you for trusting me with this, Tristan."

POST-SESSION THERAPIST CHECKLIST

IMMEDIATELY AFTER

RECORD: 1. SOAP notes (incl. verbatim client quotes): [ ]

RECORD: 2. SMART baselines: SE___ AS___ AX___ TR___ CO___ PI___: [ ]

RECORD: 3. Cycle responses: C1 (yelling low)___ C2 (yelling med)___ C3 (vulnerability)___ C4 (trust)___: [ ]

RECORD: 4. Reversal: could he summon fear? Y / N: [ ]

RECORD: 5. Anchor compound: visible response when pressed? Y / N: [ ]

RECORD: 6. Debrief: first noticed ___ shifts ___ compare to S2 “armor/shield” ___: [ ]

RECORD: 7. Group vulnerability cycle: what happened ___ nod? ___ where in body? ___: [ ]

RECORD: 8. Trust cycle: who appeared inside circle? ___ Wall disrupted? ___: [ ]

RECORD: 9. Homework not done from S2: which items? ___ barriers cited: ___: [ ]

RECORD: 10. Nightmare pattern update: ___: [ ]

RECORD: 11. Target words from S2a (confirm still same): Word 1 = ___ Word 2 = ___: [ ]

RECORD: 12. Update TM-002.json (baselines, cycle data, SOAP): [ ]

RECORD: 13. Save + send recording with listening instructions: [ ]

RECORD: 14. Send feedback form (adapt from S2 version): [ ]

RECORD: 15. CCH hours to HMI (Oct 24, 90 min, S3, T.M.): [ ]

RECORD: 16. S4 decision: advance to Circle of Trust? Repeat Circle Therapy at higher intensity? Add assertiveness? ___: [ ]

RECORD: 17. Reflection: what went well ___ what to adjust ___ emotional lane landing ___: [ ]

APPENDIX: CLIENT HANDOUT — SELF-ESTEEM TOOLKIT (GIVE TO TRISTAN)

Print this section separately or tear off. This is the client-facing take-home document.

T.M. (TM-002) | For use between sessions | Three tools: The Flip, The Reframe, The Reset | Be honest with yourself -- this works when you use it

TOOL 1: THE FLIP -- HOW SELF-ESTEEM ACTUALLY WORKS

The old model: Feel worthy first, then act worthy. Wait for confidence, then do the brave thing.

The flip: Act worthy first, and the feeling of worth follows. Self-esteem is not something you receive. It is something you **build through esteemable acts** -- actions conducted with integrity, care, and responsibility.

Every time you do one of these, you lay a brick:

Five Categories of Esteemable Acts (your "bricks"):

1. **Showing Up for Yourself:** Keep a personal commitment. Exercise. Eat well. Meditate. Listen genuinely to someone.
2. **Service to Others:** Help someone. Mentor. Volunteer. Show up for someone when it would be easier not to.
3. **Cultivating Your Surroundings:** Organize your space. Be mindful of what media you consume. Build positive environments.
4. **Authentic Expression:** Present yourself honestly. Say what you mean. Dress in a way that feels like you, not like camouflage.
5. **Personal Accountability:** Do the right thing when no one is watching. Hold your boundaries. Own your choices without shame.

The thought is weather. The label is damage. The act is the brick.

Low vs. Healthy Self-Esteem -- Know Where You Stand

DIMENSION	LOW SELF-ESTEEM	HEALTHY SELF-ESTEEM
Mistakes	Severe self-criticism, feelings of personal failure, avoidance of risk	Viewing mistakes as learning, treating yourself with compassion
Boundaries	Weak; saying "yes" to please others at your own expense	Clear and firm; comfortable saying "no" to protect time and energy
Praise	Deflecting compliments, dismissing achievements	Accepting with a simple "thank you" and feeling genuine pride
Decisions	Chronic second-guessing, relying on others to validate choices	Trusting your judgment while remaining open to feedback
Comparison	Constantly measuring against others; envy, inadequacy	Measuring progress against your own past self

TOOL 2: THE REFRAME -- CATCH IT, NAME IT, FLIP IT

When your mood drops or self-doubt spikes, use this template. Write it down -- pen and paper works better than just thinking it.

1. THE TRIGGER: What happened right before the thought?

Example: A customer was rude and I had a judgmental thought about them.

2. THE CRITIC (Automatic Thought): What exact phrase is running in your head?

Example: "I'm such an asshole for thinking that. I'm a judgmental person."

3. THE DISTORTION: What trick is your mind playing?

- **All-or-Nothing:** "If I'm not perfect, I'm a failure."
- **Catastrophizing:** "One bad thought means I'm a terrible person."

- **Mind Reading:** "Everyone can see how judgmental I am."

4. THE EVIDENCE: What are the objective facts?

Evidence supporting the thought:

Evidence contradicting the thought:

Example: I helped my friend, I showed up for therapy, I pulled someone from a river, I have genuine care for people.

5. THE BALANCED REALITY: Fair, realistic substitute statement.

Example: "I had a reactive thought about someone who was being difficult. That was human. It does not define me. I have a track record of care and integrity, and my next act is what builds my worth."

The critic says "you ARE a failure." The coach says "that attempt failed. What's your next move?"

TOOL 3: THE RESET -- SOMATIC TECHNIQUES

When self-criticism triggers an emotional spiral, your nervous system reads it as a physical threat (fight-or-flight). To quiet the mind, you first signal safety to the body.

A. The Physiological Sigh (fastest reset -- 10 seconds)

1. Two quick, deep inhalations through your nose: one deep breath, then immediately a sharp second "top-off" sip of air.
2. One long, slow exhale through your mouth -- as slow as you can.
3. Repeat 2-3 times. This instantly triggers your parasympathetic nervous system and lowers your heart rate.

When to use: The moment you catch a harsh self-label firing. Before the spiral starts.

B. The 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding Technique

Instead of fighting the thought, redirect your focus outward through your senses:

- **Level 1:** Notice **5 things you can see** around you.
- **Level 2:** Touch **4 distinct textures** nearby (clothes, desk, cool glass, fabric).
- **Level 3:** Listen for **3 distinct sounds**.
- **Level 4:** Identify **2 things you can smell or taste**.
- **Level 5:** Take **1 deep nasal breath**. Clench your jaw lightly for 3 seconds. Release completely. Let shoulders drop.

Why it works: Shifts processing from the hyper-reactive amygdala back to your immediate physical reality. The spiral cannot sustain itself when your attention is anchored in the present.

C. Peripheral Vision Expansion (Open Monitoring)

1. Fix your gaze on a single point on the wall straight ahead.
2. Without moving your eyes, slowly allow your awareness to expand outward -- left and right -- taking in your entire peripheral field of vision.
3. Hold the expanded awareness for 15-30 seconds.

Why it works: Broadening your visual field mechanically disrupts the intense "tunnel vision" associated with stress and stress-hormone production. Your nervous system cannot maintain a fight-or-flight response while in panoramic vision mode.

THE STACK: PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

When a harsh thought fires, use this sequence:

1. **Physiological Sigh** (2-3 breaths) -- stop the spiral in your body first
2. **Anchor** (thumb + forefinger, right hand, one breath) -- activate the circle + tribe + workshop
3. **Read the label** -- what did the critic just print?
4. **Name the distortion** -- all-or-nothing? catastrophizing? mind reading?
5. **Fact-check** -- objective fact or emotional reaction?
6. **Replace** -- write the balanced truth (even just in your head)
7. **Choose the next esteemable act** -- lay a brick. Any brick. Move.

Sigh. Anchor. Read. Name. Check. Replace. Build.

If a spiral feels overwhelming:

1. Physiological Sigh (2-3 times) + anchor (thumb + forefinger)
2. 5-4-3-2-1 grounding if the sigh is not enough
3. Email Jeeth: jeeth@vrishihypno.com (24-hour response)
4. If urgent: call or text **988** (24/7)